SUPERVISE

An actor needs to supervise the actors that it creates. The `Supervisor` in the chat application can keep track of what's happening to the main components, as shown in figure 1.18.

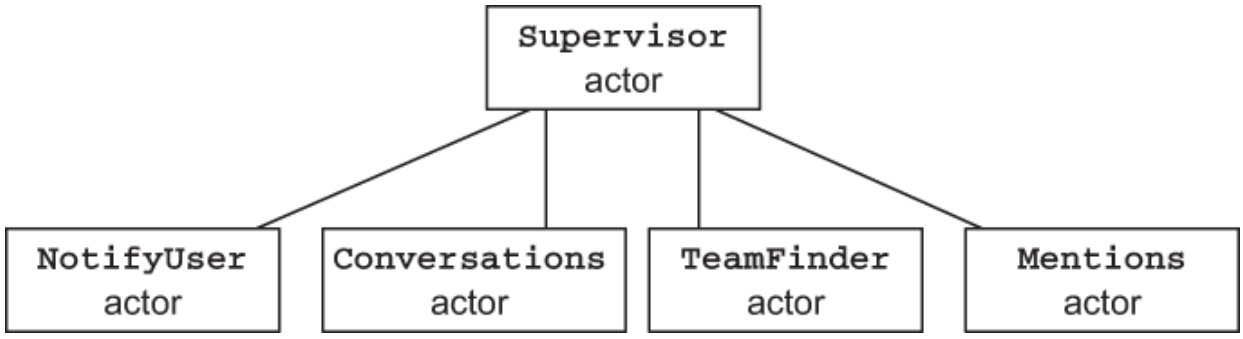


Figure 1.18 Supervising actors

The `Supervisor` decides what should happen when components fail in the system. For example, it can decide that the chat application continues when the `Mentions` component and the `NotifyUser` actor have crashed since they're not critical components. The `Supervisor` is notified with special messages that indicate which actor has crashed and for what reason. The `Supervisor` can decide to restart an actor or take the actor out of service.

Any actor can be a supervisor, but only for the actors it creates. In figure 1.19, the `TeamFinder` actor supervises the two connectors for looking up contacts. In this case, it could take the `OutlookContacts` actor out of service because it failed too often. The `TeamFinder` would then continue looking up contacts from Google only.